

1) What drives people to act or behave in such extraordinary ways?

Ans) Extraordinary behaviour in crises is not spontaneous heroism but the result of deeply internalised values shaped by organisational culture. When individuals strongly identify with organisational purpose, they act beyond self interest. Value based recruitment and socialisation ensure that employees rely on moral judgement rather than rules or rewards in high-pressure situations. Psychological ownership further motivates such behaviour, as employees see themselves as custodians of the organisation. A strong sense of purpose, reinforced by leadership, prioritises human life and ethical responsibility over personal safety or organisational assets.

2) What are these organisations doing differently to enable such behaviour?

Ans) The organisations design systems that emphasize values, trust and autonomy rather than rigid control. Through values-based recruitment and cultural alignment, discretionary employee actions remain consistent with organisational intent. Extensive training is followed by trust in employee judgment, allowing improvisation when situation demand it. Leadership reinforces this trust by clearly communicating confidence in employees' decision. Additionally organisational culture and recognition systems legitimise and

organisational culture and recognition systems legitimise such behaviours. By standardising values instead of behaviours and aligning HRM practices with purpose, these organisations enable employees to act responsibly and courageously in extraordinary situations.